

The money on the table — and where the salary actually goes

Money & Momentum.

The grants he qualifies for with their deadlines, the hiring edge most students never use, and how an \$80K start becomes far more.

The grants — with deadlines

Honestly filtered: what he actually qualifies for, and what to skip

GRANT	AMOUNT	ELIGIBLE?	WHEN TO APPLY
NSERC USRA	~\$6,000	YES	Apply Jan–Feb 2027 for that summer (after 2 terms), via the Guelph dept
OEN–Bruce Power Nuclear Studies	\$3,500	YES	Opens ~Feb–Mar; first shot Spring 2027 (after 1 yr), via Electro-Federation Canada
Canadian Nuclear Society research	~\$7,000 (\$2K + ~\$5K supervisor match	YES	After 2nd year; needs a faculty supervisor. Join CNS (free) now
EHRC "Empowering Futures"	\$5–7K (paid to the employer)	YES	Any work term — he <i>names it</i> when applying to make himself cheaper to hire
Bruce Power \$500 scholarships	\$500	MAYBE	May 15–Jun 15 — only if he's from Bruce / Grey / Huron county
OPG in-course awards	varies	MAYBE	Check Guelph's awards office (flagship one is engineering-only)
WiN Canada scholarship	\$3,000	NO	Women only — not eligible

DO THESE TWO THINGS NOW

1. Have him **join the Canadian Nuclear Society** (free student membership — also a signal of intent). 2. Put **NSERC USRA (Jan–Feb 2027)** and the **OEN–Bruce Power \$3,500 (Spring 2027)** on the calendar as the two real targets. Everything else is opportunistic.

The hiring edge most students never use

A way to make employers want him — because he's partly free

The federal **EHRC "Empowering Futures"** program pays an *employer* up to **\$5,000** (or **\$7,000** for a first-year student) to take on a student in an energy-sector work term. When Marcus applies — especially to a smaller lab or

company — he can say plainly: "hiring me is partly subsidized through EHRC Empowering Futures." It makes him the cheap, easy yes. Almost no 19-year-old knows to do this. He should.

Where the salary actually goes

\$80K out of school — and the real ladder from there

\$50-80K

EARNED ACROSS HIS 4 CO-OP TERMS

\$80-95K

STARTING FULL-TIME SALARY

ROUTE	PATH & TOP END
Standard — technical	Station/lab chemist → senior → supervisor. \$110–140K by ~30, plus a defined-benefit pension worth ~\$1.3M.
Superior — leadership / consulting	P.Eng + MBA → director/VP or energy consulting. \$180K–\$1M/yr ; multi-million net worth.
Elite — founder / C-suite	Radiopharma founder, or executive. Verified ceilings: OPG CNO \$1.09M , CEO \$1.6M ; a radiopharma exit (Fusion) hit \$2.4B .

THE HONEST VERSION

The \$80–95K start is **near-certain** if he executes. The six-figure-plus and the millions are **earned, not guaranteed** — they come from the credentials (P.Eng, maybe MBA), the niche (radiopharma), and the network. But the floor is high and the ceiling is real and verified. Few degrees can say both.

Full employer hit-list (pharma, radiopharma, CROs, startups) and the founder-funding ladder are in the "Inside Track" section of this binder. Salary figures: Ontario co-op & Sunshine List data; career ranges are estimates and vary.